

Malaria

Malaria spreads through mosquito bites. It is dangerous, especially for babies, young children and pregnant women. Malaria can be cured, and the medicine is free at health facilities.

For community members

Key messages

- Sleep under a treated mosquito net every night. Nets should be replaced about every three years. Check yours for holes.
- If you have a fever, get tested within 24 hours at the health facility. A rapid test or a blood test shows if it is malaria. Do not just guess.
- Do not take malaria medicine only because you have a fever. Take it when a test shows malaria.
- If the test shows malaria, take the medicine for the full three days, even if you feel better after the first day. If you

are not better after three days, go back.

- Pregnant women should take the malaria prevention tablets (Fansidar) they are given at antenatal care.
- Clear bush and empty puddles around your house, where mosquitoes breed. Use repellent at night if you can afford it.

Go to the hospital or health centre now if there is

- Fits or confusion
- Being very sleepy or hard to wake
- Vomiting again and again, or not able to drink
- Fast or difficult breathing
- Very pale skin or yellow eyes
- Fever in a pregnant woman or a baby

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.